



The big picture

Entertain helps you organize the meals you host at home: build a menu from your own dishes, and the app works out the ingredients and hands you back a shopping list sorted by supplier.

Two reusable catalogs sit at the core — your **ingredients** and your **dishes** — which you build up over time. Then come the **events**: a lunch, a dinner, a gathering. For each one you compose a menu from your dishes, and the app turns it into a supplier-grouped shopping list. Build the catalogs once, reuse them for every event.

First time, step by step

If this is your first time in the app, follow these in order. After that, you'll move around however you like.

1. Set things up in Settings

Open the Settings tab first. Set your greeting and signature — these top and tail the order messages the app drafts for suppliers, so they read like something you wrote.

Then open Suppliers. You'll see the built-in categories: butcher, fishmonger, greengrocer, supermarket, pantry. Give the ones you use a name and a contact, so orders go to the right place.

Tip: every main screen has a small help icon by its title if you get stuck.

2. Add a few ingredients

In the Ingredients tab, add the things you cook with. Each one gets a default unit (grams, units, a bottle...) and a default supplier (which shop it comes from).

Those defaults are what let the app build a tidy shopping list later. Add just enough for your first dish — you can always add more.

3. Create a dish or two

In the Dishes tab, create a dish: add its ingredients with quantities, plus a base number of servings (how many people the recipe is written for).

4. Create your first event

In the Events tab, add an event: a type (lunch, dinner), a format (seated, buffet), a date, and the number of guests.

Guest count and format both matter — they're what the app uses to work out quantities, as the next step explains.

5. Build the event's menu

Open the event and go to its Menu tab. Add dishes from your catalog.

A dish added to an event becomes **its own copy**: adjust its ingredients or servings for this occasion and the original catalog dish stays exactly as it was.

How servings start depends on the format. A **seated** event scales each dish to your guest count automatically — everyone gets a serving of each. A **buffet** keeps the dish's catalog servings, since people serve themselves. Either way, you can fine-tune afterwards.

At the top of the Menu tab there's a running total: dishes, servings, and **servings per guest** — a quick check on whether you've planned enough food.

As a rough guide, a well-balanced menu lands around **3 to 5 servings per guest** across the whole menu. It's a guideline, not a rule — a light lunch sits lower, a feast higher. If you're far outside that range, take a second look at your servings, especially for a buffet where you set them yourself.

6. Shop by supplier

Switch to the event's Shopping tab. Every ingredient is gathered here, grouped by supplier, each with a status you tap through — to order, ordered, received, already at home. Each supplier header shows the running tally without opening it.

When you're ready, the app drafts the order message using the greeting and signature from step 1. You can also add **extra** items to a supplier's order — things you want to buy that aren't part of the event.